NPC LOGBOOK #1: Group SimSimi

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Week: Week 5

1) **Task Completed**

A) Concept Overview & Core Theme

a. Core Idea: A strategy tower defense game inspired by *Plants vs. Zombies*, where players use native Sarawak wildlife as hero characters to protect hornbill nesting sites from poachers and habitat loss.

b. Folklore & Story: Set in an apocalyptic world where wildlife is critically endangered and fetching exorbitant prices on the black market, global poachers hunt rare species like the Rhinoceros Hornbill.

c. Campaign & Stages: The game spans multiple global stages, featuring region-specific enemies. In Borneo specifically, the campaign consists of 5 distinct stages, each pitting players against unique poacher teams utilizing deforestation and hunting tools.

B) Gameplay & Mechanics

a. Battlefield Layout: A chess-style tactical grid representing the Sarawak rainforest canopy.

b. Economy & Resources:

i. Forest Energy: Collected from falling leaves of the Rhinoceros Hornbill Nest tree (acting like the sun in *PvZ*) to purchase defensive units during matches.

ii. Funding & Upgrades: Players can participate in side quests and mini-games to earn community funding, which is used between stages to upgrade existing units and unlock new ones.

C) Factions & Characters

a. Defensive Units (Guardians):

i. Native Sarawak wildlife units deployed to intercept intruders (e.g., Orangutans, Hornbills, Porcupines, and Crocodiles), with specialized "Jungle Patrol" units available across the Borneo stages.

b. Enemy Units (Poachers):

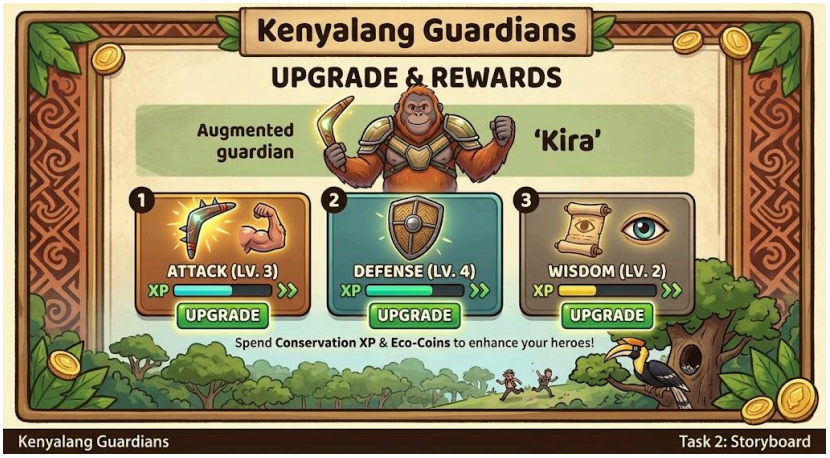
i. International poachers equipped with specialized hunting gear and deforestation tools such as chainsaws, parangs, and firearms.

2) Evidence

a) Main Games Prototype:

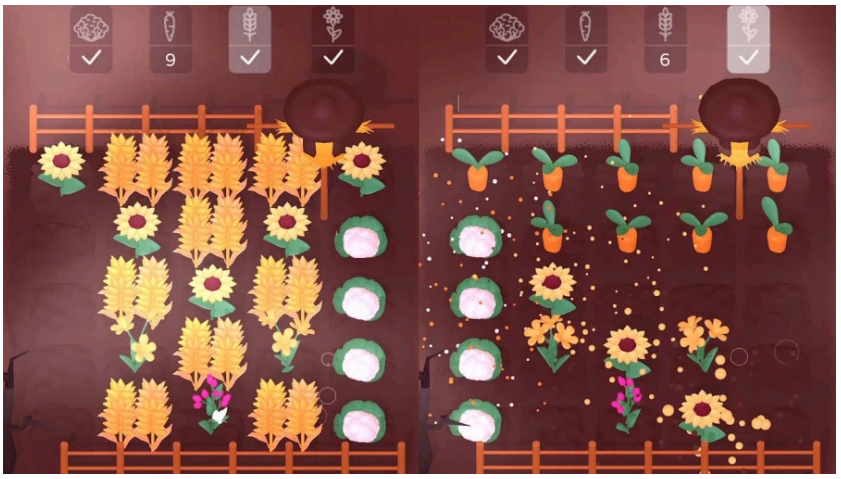


b) Upgradeable Jungle Patrol Units:





c) **Example of mini games and side quests for Funding:**







3) **Issue or challenge**
    a) Challenge 1: Side Quests & Mini-Games (Balancing Education & Fun)
        i. To solve the difficulty of tying mini-games to both funding and environmental education without feeling disconnected, split the mini-games into two thematic categories that directly support the main campaign:
    b) Challenge 2: Choosing the Right Art Style.
        i. Since your primary target is primary school students, the art style needs to balance an approachable, friendly look with clear educational readability.
    c) Challenge 3: Designing Global Poachers Without Targeting Specific Countries.
        i. To keep the game fun, educational, and universally appealing for primary school students without pointing fingers or offending any specific nation, you can frame the international poachers as fictional, syndicate-based ecological threat groups rather than nationalities.
        ii.
    d) Challenge 4: Balancing Gameplay Difficulty and Educational Pacing for Young Players
        i. Because the game integrates multiple mechanics—managing Forest Energy (sun resource), protecting the nest from global poachers, playing side quests for funding, restoring habitats, and caring for baby hornbills there is a risk of cognitive overload for primary school students.
        ii. Why It's a Challenge: If the tower defense strategy is too hard, kids get frustrated. If the educational side quests and mini-games feel like a tedious "chore" rather than a fun break, they lose interest in the conservation message.
4) **Next Action**
    a) **Gameplay & Mechanics Focus**:
        i. Prototyping the core Borneo stage levels and designing the habitat-planting mini-game mechanics to balance resource management and educational pacing for primary school students.
    b) **Comprehensive Milestone Focus**:
        i. Building a playable proof-of-concept level for Stage 1 (Borneo) integrating the Forest Energy economy, defensive wildlife placement, and the baby hornbill nurturing side quest.